



PROGRESS REPORT

Madagascar: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-25 · 66 systems and instruments tracked

Of 66 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 35 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-25, 15 did not, 8 carry no stated baseline, and 8 are **Not held** at both ends.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Shape check, run before the comparison: 72 sources for this place in the window — 28 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 44 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-08). The two halves are comparable, so the comparison is made over the whole window.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

One programme accounts for most of the movement. Biometric enrolment went from [vendors contracted and nothing under way to more than six million adults registered](#), a law of 28 May 2026 opened mass birth registration inside that operation, about 10 million civil records were digitised, and the national interoperability platform went live across five public bodies.

The governing layer moved from nothing to bills. A [cybercrime bill was adopted by the Council of Ministers](#) and an [electronic-signature decree was validated](#), neither enacted, while the [data-protection commission stood unconstituted at both ends of the period](#).

Two positions worsened. The state acquired a [filtering mandate by cabinet decision with no instrument behind it](#), and the [dominant mobile money platform migrated its core system and broke for two months](#).

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Technical Assistance Facility for the Refondation	Did not exist	Launched; 170 focal points certified and proposals submitted through a dedicated platform by end-July 2026 (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Plan Strategique Numerique 2023-2028	In force	In force; no published implementation report held	NO CHANGE

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Cybercrime bill overhauling the 2014 law	The 2014 law unamended	Bill adopted by the Council of Ministers and not enacted; it would define security incidents and critical infrastructure organisations, revise electronic evidence and connection-data retention, and require operator cooperation with justice. Revision was reported again on 2026-08-15 alongside signature of the United Nations Convention against Cybercrime and accession to the World AI Cooperation Organization, with Interpol findings that artificial-intelligence-enabled fraud is outpacing African states' response capacity given as the reason	ADVANCED
Dedicated social-media law	Did not exist	Announced; no draft held (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Electronic signature and interoperability decree	The 2015 electronic-signature law without an implementing decree	Draft decree validated and not adopted; a national interoperability committee provided for (2025-09)	ADVANCED
Order to block pornographic sites at internet service provider level	Did not exist	In force as a cabinet decision; no timetable, technical mechanism, named regulator or appeal route specified (2026-07)	ADVANCED

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Commission Malagasy de l'Informatique et des Libertes (CMIL)	Provided for, not constituted	Provided for, not constituted; no later account held	NO CHANGE
Data-protection law (loi n 2014-038)	In force, unenforced	In force, unenforced	NO CHANGE

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
China-initiated international network against cybercrime	Not held	Accession approved by the Council of Ministers on 4 August 2026, mobilising the foreign affairs, justice, public-security, digital-development and gendarmerie ministries for cross-border cooperation on online fraud	BASELINE NOT HELD
United Nations Convention against Cybercrime	Not held	Signed, on the account of 2026-08-15, with no ratification instrument, parliamentary submission or implementing legislation on record	BASELINE NOT HELD

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Mobile money open API conformance	Conformant	Conformant	NO CHANGE

Nothing was enacted in the period. The [cybercrime bill](#) went from the 2014 law unamended to a bill adopted by the Council of Ministers, and the [electronic-signature and interoperability decree](#) from an eleven-year-old law without implementing text to a validated draft. Both stand short of the statute book.

What did not move is the part that matters for the data the period generated. The [data-protection law was in force and its supervisory commission unconstituted at both ends](#) — the same position it has held since 2015 — so six million biometric enrolments, ten million digitised civil records and a police platform taking sensitive reports all entered the record with no supervisory authority in existence.

The one instrument that did take effect took effect without being an instrument. The Council of Ministers [ordered site blocking by cabinet decision, with no timetable, mechanism, named regulator or appeal route](#), and a [dedicated social-media law was announced](#) with no draft held. Administrative reform gained a [technical assistance facility running to 2030](#).

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Airtel Mobile Commerce guarantee (MIGA)	Committed	Committed; no implementation record held	NO CHANGE
Digital Governance and Identification Management System project (World Bank)	Committed	Committed; closed 30 June 2026 with the identity component continuing	NO CHANGE
Financial Inclusion Project (World Bank)	Committed and restructured	Committed and restructured; no later implementation record held	NO CHANGE
Governance digitisation project (African Development Bank)	Committed	Committed; no implementation record held	NO CHANGE
Telecommunications modernisation loan (China Eximbank)	Committed	Committed; no implementation record held	NO CHANGE
WeLight solar mini-grid and rural electrification (Norfund)	Committed	Committed; no implementation record held	NO CHANGE

The [Fonds DECIM affordable-device facility](#) moved from a closed call with nothing contracted to a US\$2.5m first call for funds in November 2025, and its digital-skills sub-component committed US\$15m to advanced digital-skills training, though the sub-component carries no baseline against which to measure movement.

External finance did not move over the period: the [World Bank identity project closed on 30 June 2026](#) with its identity component continuing, and every other tracked external commitment stood as committed at both ends with no implementation record.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
5G-Advanced trial (Yas and Huawei)	Did not exist	Trial run; no commercial 5G service on record (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Airtel and Eutelsat OneWeb rural broadband	Not on record	Partnership deepened; no rural site count or subscriber figure published (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Antananarivo-Mahajanga fibre backbone (Orange)	Did not exist	558 km in service, built by the country's third fibre operator (2025-12)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
DARE1 subsea cable extension to Madagascar	No subsea extension on record	Extension announced on a 3,200-3,500 km leg via Tanzania and Mozambique, ready for service 2028	ADVANCED
Digital and Energy Connectivity for Inclusion project (DECIM)	US\$375m envelope with the rural-connectivity tender document due end-October 2025	Tender document slipped to January 2026; 664,000 devices distributed by the June 2026 review	ADVANCED, SLIPPED
Starlink Direct-to-Cell service	Did not exist	First trial run on Airtel spectrum, the third African country to do so; commercial launch pending the regulator (2026-07)	ADVANCED
AXIAN 4G and 5G expansion programme	US\$82m of the operator's own investment and a US\$100m EIB loan committed (2025-04)	Unchanged; no coverage or site figure published since	NO CHANGE
Satellite connectivity for ten enclaved zones (DECIM)	Announced, nothing connected	Announced, nothing connected; no site or date published	NO CHANGE

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National data centres (Tsimbazaza and Iavoloha)	Tenders opened for rehabilitation of the main data centre and the identity-card personalisation centre (2025-12)	Two renewable-powered centres confirmed as securing the identity system; no commissioning date published (2026-06)	ADVANCED

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National cybersecurity strategy	Did not exist	Launched with a three-month delivery target; no strategy document published (2026-08)	ADVANCED

Fibre and satellite advanced; the international leg did not arrive. Orange's 558 km Antananarivo-Mahajanga backbone went from not existing to in service, and the DARE1 extension moved from no record to announced for service in 2028. On satellite, Direct-to-Cell went from not existing to a first trial in July 2026 with commercial launch still pending the regulator, and a low-earth-orbit rural partnership deepened. The 5G-Advanced trial in July 2026 likewise did not exist at the period's start.

Against those, the arrangement to connect ten enclaved zones stood unchanged at both ends, with no site connected, and AXIAN's committed 4G and 5G money produced no published coverage figure at either date.

The public connectivity project advanced and slipped in the same file. DECIM's rural-connectivity tender document, due end-October 2025, moved to January 2026 because the mapping had to descend to fokontany rather than commune level, while 664,000 devices were distributed by the June 2026 review. Hosting moved from tender to confirmed without a commissioning date, and the national cybersecurity strategy launched with a three-month delivery target has produced no document eight months on.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Rahaka national interoperability platform	Platform expansion out to tender (2025-08)	Operational at the investment board, the social-security fund, the statistics institute, the justice ministry and the tax directorate (2026-04)	ADVANCED

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Biometric enrolment kits and centres	Kits contracted, not deployed (2025-05)	2,500 kits across 1,729 centres, six days a week; the January pilot enrolled about 130,000 across 116 centres in 26 communes (2026-04)	ADVANCED
PRODIGY biometric national identity enrolment	Vendors contracted, no enrolment under way (2025-05)	More than six million adults enrolled in the April to June 2026 phase; a second phase in preparation (2026-07)	ADVANCED

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Airtel Money and Baobab Bank integration	Did not exist	Bidirectional wallet-to-account transfers over USSD and the bank's application (2026-07)	ADVANCED
AXIAN Digibank and Fintech	Mobile money operator	Digital-bank strategy announced across five markets, serving about 500,000 merchants a month (2025-11)	ADVANCED
e-Ariary central bank digital currency	Testing announced, no vendor (2025-05)	Vendor selected; the central bank sole issuer with private distribution, and no live pilot reported (2025-10)	ADVANCED
MVola mobile money platform	In service on the previous core platform	Migrated to a new core platform; May and June 2026 outages and balance-display faults reported and stated by the operator as regularised (2026-08)	ADVANCED, SERVICE DISRUPTED DURING MIGRATION
Orange Money Pro	In service	In service; no take-up figures published	NO CHANGE

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Civil-record digitisation	Did not exist	About 10 million records digitised using mobile satellite and solar units (2026-05)	ADVANCED
Electoral roll reconstitution	Existing roll, contested	Full reconstitution under way through five registration channels, gated on presentation of a national identity card (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Mass birth-registration law	Late birth registration only through a costly judicial process	Mass registration permitted within enrolment, with over 2,000 teams and more than 19,000 fokontany chiefs confirming identities against a de-duplicated database (2026-05)	ADVANCED
Civil registry and database management contract (IN Groupe)	Awarded	Awarded; no delivery milestone published	NO CHANGE

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Higher-education accreditation platform	Did not exist	In service; 546 applications received as at 10 July 2026, of which about 250 expected at the session opening 21 September 2026	ADVANCED
Police reporting platform for violence and disappearances	Did not exist	In service 24 hours a day on web and an Android application in Malagasy and French, with anonymous filing and a citizen-visible reference number (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Development fund human-resources ERP	Not held	Out to tender: the social-protection fund is recruiting a consultancy to build a human-resources management ERP under a World Bank-financed social safety nets and resilience project, with bids due 26 August 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD
Maritime Single Window	Not held	Being deployed as a platform centralising port administrative procedures, financed by Indonesia's international development agency at more than 3.4bn Indonesian rupiah, about 816m ariary, through the port, maritime and river agency, and announced at the launch of a bilateral cooperation programme	BASELINE NOT HELD

This is where the period's work is. Biometric enrolment moved from vendors contracted and nothing running to more than six million adults registered in the April to June 2026 phase, by way of a pilot that enrolled about 130,000 through regime change, civil unrest and a cyclone and a proof of concept validated in March 2026 that released 2,500 kits nationwide.

The legal route into the register changed with it. Late birth registration went from a costly judicial process to mass registration inside the enrolment operation under a law of 28 May 2026, with more than 19,000 fokontany chiefs confirming undocumented identities against a de-duplicated database and an offline-first last-mile model. Behind it, about 10 million civil records were digitised where none had been.

Interoperability moved from procurement to production: Rahaka went from a tender to expand the platform to operation across five public bodies. Two citizen-facing services appeared outside the main programme — the police reporting platform and the higher-education accreditation platform — and the register became load-bearing for elections when the commission opened a full reconstitution of the electoral roll gated on the identity card.

Payments are the exception. MVola replaced its core platform and the service broke in May and June 2026, accounted for by the operator alone with no regulator named and no incident report published. The e-Ariary went from testing announced to a vendor selected and no live pilot, while Airtel Money and Baobab Bank opened wallet-to-account transfers and AXIAN announced a digital-bank strategy.

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
ATLAS Umoja African-language AI partnership	Did not exist	Founding partnership announced; no Malagasy-language model or dataset released (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Madagascar-Egypt partnership on AI in public administration	Not on record	Reported; no date of signature, text or figure (2026-08)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Customs data and artificial-intelligence centre (CEDIA)	In operation, with the Enhanced Risk Assessment targeting system and a data warehouse	In operation; no later account or performance figure held	NO CHANGE
World AI Cooperation Organization membership	Not held	Joined, on the account of 2026-08-15, alongside revision of the cybercrime law and signature of the United Nations cybercrime convention; the country still holds no national artificial-intelligence strategy	BASELINE NOT HELD

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital entrepreneurship environment	Not established	Placed behind regional comparators on the 2025 VIGS index reported by UNDP (2025-12)	BASELINE NOT HELD

Applied artificial intelligence was already in service and did not change: the [customs data and AI centre was in operation at both ends of the period](#) with no later performance figure published. What moved is announcement. AXIAN was [named a founding partner of an African-language AI initiative](#) with nothing released, and a [Madagascar-Egypt partnership on AI in public administration was reported without a signature date](#). No national AI strategy entered the record at either end, which is the position to hold against a year in which AI indexed ten million civil records.

Capacity

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Ministry recruitment of specialist digital posts	Did not exist	259 applications received by 1 August 2026 for posts in artificial intelligence, data management, digital innovation, cybersecurity, telecommunications and digital law; no appointment announced	ADVANCED
DECIM digital skills sub-component	Not established	US\$15m committed, with 5,700 people to be trained in advanced digital skills and US\$2.4m for the national research network (2025-11)	BASELINE NOT HELD

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
UNIPOD university connectivity and AI initiative	Did not exist	Announced; no campus connected or facility opened on record (2026-01)	ADVANCED

Inclusion

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Fonds DECIM affordable-device facility	April 2025 call for applications closed, none contracted	Nine applications approved, with only two operator contracts unsigned; a student-laptop pilot proposed for about 700 computers (2025-11)	ADVANCED
Mobile internet tariff reduction agreement	A standoff between the state and the operators	Agreement reached; no price schedule or reduction figure published (2025-12)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Active mobile money users	Not established	Six to seven million active users against a population of about thirty million (2026-08)	BASELINE NOT HELD

Affordability was addressed by agreement and cannot be scored. Operators [agreed in December 2025 to cut mobile internet prices gradually against excise-duty relief](#), resolving a standoff; no price schedule or reduction figure has been published since, so the position at the end of the period is an agreement without a number.

Device access moved inside the donor project: the [Fonds DECIM went from a closed call with nothing contracted to nine approved applications](#), with two operator contracts still unsigned. Skills sit in the same file and carry no baseline: a sub-component [committing to train 5,700 people in advanced digital skills](#) is stated as a commitment, not as delivery.

The state's own capability is being recruited for rather than reported on. The digital ministry [drew 259 applications for ten specialist posts](#) where no such recruitment stood at the period's start, and a [university connectivity and AI initiative was announced](#) with no campus connected.

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
INSTAT microdata sharing platform	Did not exist	Registration-gated platform at microdata.instat.mg advertising ERISC household surveys 2020-2022, an ERISC enterprise survey and RGPH 3 census microdata; no dataset documentation, sample size, licence or reuse terms established beyond the landing page (2026-08)	ADVANCED

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Assemblée nationale open-data portal	Did not exist	Live REST API serving five datasets (deputies, legislative texts, sittings, committees, parliamentary groups) as JSON and CSV, rate-limited to 60 requests a minute, under Licence Ouverte v2.0 (CC-BY compatible); page counters read 163 deputies, 45 texts and 128 sittings (2026-08-09)	ADVANCED
Open government data portal or policy	No portal, open-data policy or public-sector information reuse instrument held	Institution-specific resources confirmed: a licensed parliamentary open-data API, a gated national-statistics microdata platform and an unconfirmed general portal (opendata.mg); the finance ministry's own portal does not resolve; no whole-of-government open-data policy or mandate is held (2026-08)	ADVANCED
OpenData Madagascar portal (opendata.mg)	Did not exist	Reachable landing page with six undated category tiles (Entreprise, Gouvernement, Education, Environnement, eCommerce, Sante) and four unlinked project cards; no issuing institution, dataset count or licence stated (2026-08)	ADVANCED

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Earth-observation or geospatial data programme	A national earth-observation or geospatial-data programme document, or an agency mandate covering satellite data.	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Municipal or communal digital service delivery	A municipal or communal digital-service platform, mandate or published local e-government plan.	not yet probed
Civil-society or parliamentary record on digital governance	A civil-society, parliamentary or press-freedom account of digital governance in Madagascar.	not yet probed
National artificial-intelligence strategy	A national AI strategy or policy document, or a ministerial decision establishing one.	2026-08-09
Indian digital cooperation with Madagascar	Any India-Madagascar digital cooperation agreement, line of credit or programme document.	not yet probed
Domestic budget appropriation for digital transformation	The loi de finances or its annexes showing appropriation lines for the digital ministry, the Digital Governance Unit or the identity office.	2026-08-09
Digital literacy programme or measurement	A digital-literacy programme document, or a published measurement of digital literacy.	not yet probed
United States bilateral health agreement and its data-sharing agreement	The memorandum of understanding and the related data-sharing agreement themselves, a signature date, or a Malagasy government statement naming the instrument. The text is withheld rather than unpublished, and is in litigation in the United States District Court for the District of Columbia	not yet probed

All eight were unheld at both ends, so none registers as movement. The set is narrower than the systems it sits beside, and that is the finding: a period in which six million people were enrolled biometrically and ten million civil records digitised produced no open-data portal, no domestic budget line, no digital-literacy measurement and no civil-society or parliamentary account of any of it. Each was probed on 9 August 2026 and none returned a document.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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